1 Tips to Enhance your Emotional Intelligence

Checking-in: Practice asking: "*What am I Thinking, Feeling and Doing, right now?*". Be able to put words to your feelings. Emotion wheel. Be present and grounded during moments of stress.

Five Senses Grounding Technique

- 5 see — 5 things that you see. Name them.
- 4 hear — Observe 4 things that you hear. Name them.
- 3 touch — Name 3 things that you are able to touch.
- 2 taste — Connect with 2 things that you can taste.
- 1 smell — 1 thing that you can smell

Now identify any shift that you noticed. Calmer? More focused?

Practice connecting your mind and body: notice if your heartbeat increases, muscles are tense, breathing, etc. Self awareness.

Neuroception: the brain scans the environment for danger and threat, in that case the brain reacts be figuring out what is happening inside => called interoception. Turn your head from side to side to scan if you are in physical danger right now. Notice that you are safe and not in danger. Maybe you notice that you yawn: you are activating your vagus nerve that is in charge of you staying calm and entering rest and digest mode. Vegus nerve: the longest nerve of the autonomic nervous system

Identify and interrupt your emotional triggers: Identify if the present feels like a past experience, and you are reacting because of that.

4-7-8 breathing: develop the ability to control your breathing

- Inhale for 4 seconds through your nose
- Hold your breath for 7 seconds
- Exhale through your mouth for 8 seconds.

Body scan meditation: notice all the parts of your body

Grounding: four elements:

- Earth: set down and close your eyes. Notice your feet on the ground, in this moment and rooted in this Earth
- Air: take three 4-7-8 breaths
- Water: create saliva in your month. Drink water and notice water down the esophagus
- Fire: inlight your imagination by envisioning a place, real or imagined, where you feel at peace

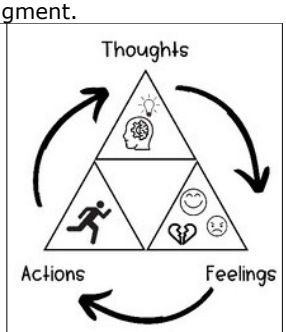
The Spiral technique: imagine astressful situation. How does it feel? Is the stomach a know? Is it a spiral? Clockwise or counter clockwise? Imagine reversing the spiral.

The idea that anger is a bad emotion is a judgement on the feeling. In reality there are no bad emotions. Emotions are cueues to your internal state. Observe uncomfortable emotions and approach them with curiosity instead of judgment.

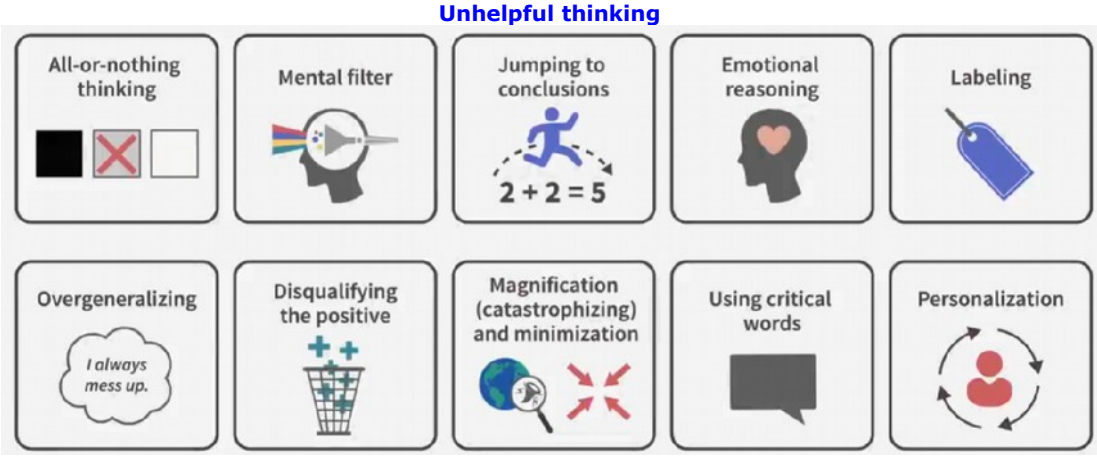
Thoughts , feelings and actions form a triangle. They are interconnected. If you are not ok, the body language and the actions show this. Your thoughts and feelings are not facts, they are valid, but they do not represent the reality of the situation.

Feeling incompetent: these feelings signal to you that you have an unmet need.

Just because you have at thought or feeling, it does not mean that it is based on reality. Challenge unhelpful thinking to shift mindset and emotional state from disempowerment to empowerment.



Unhelpful thinking



2 Driving Your Career in a Direction that is Right for you.

LinkedIn Learning – Anita Rolls (https://careerintelligenceacademy.com/). They propose a framework called Career Intelligence

Career mindsets:

- **Passenger** = autopilot. "I'll wait for something to happen". Useful when you are young
- **Hitch-hiker**: based on reactive or random choices, or based on what you don't want. Throw everything at the wall and see what sticks.
- **Driver**: you take responsability. *I'll start where I am, use what I have and do what I can and if it does not work out, I'll learn and move on*.

There are trends that prevent people from getting to the driver seat:

- increasing complexity in the outer world
- increased distraction in our inner worlds:
  - more things competing for our attention (employees are expected to do more)
  - home and life are blurring
  - mental health struggles

To balance these trends: create a dynamic plan for your professional life.

The four hats concepts: if you own a business, you have to work in the business (e.g. selling) and on the business (get new customers, etc). If you are an employee, you have to work in your career and on your career.

Four hats: each in an area that you must pay attention to: work in and on.

- **COO** (Operational): work in your career. Responsabilities
  - You must add value that maps to the overall success of the organization. Shift from job based thinking to value creating thinking, in your current role.
  - Make sure you have what you need to do your kob in a sustainable way: resources, support, training. Focus on working smarter, not harder.
- **CFO** (Financial) career must be profitable, given your definition of success. Career outcomes. Profitability= income and success in general: the key is knowing yourself better.
  - Create some desired outcomes for your career in the context of your life overall: meaninful. Create some **tickables** (somethink you can thick-off) Without tickables you may struggle to feel motivated in what you do.
  - Define your own measures of success. Trackables. You never finish them, but you must make sure that you have enough of them.
- **CMO** (marketing): develop the skills to be known across the organization and beyond, to attract future opportunities. Reputation and relationships: People must know that the product exists and what it offers. You must be known and known about.
  - Manage your personal brand: your brand if what people say when you are not in the room (quote from J.Bezos).
  - Identify the relationships you must cultivate to achieve sustainable success in your career. They are called career stakeholders. Have a system to monitor and track.
- **CIO** (innovation): keep scanning the environment to ensure you are still relevant. The CIO manages your development and progression to help you reach more of your unique potential
  - Managing your development: how I am growing?
  - Taking charge of your progression. *Asking: "where am I going?"* Notice the trends in the outer world and create opportunities for yourself that align with the needs of the organization.

COO Role	Wellbeing: low	Wellbeing: high
Performance: high	Running on empty: great results, but at the expense of your well being. Not sustainable, and can lead to burnout	Sustainable value.
Performance: low	Questionable fit.	Opportunity cost: maybe other opprtunities could be better. You are protecting your wellbaing by doing the minimum.

CFO: motivation and satisfaction.	Satisfaction: low	Satisfaction: high
Motivation: high	Busy but unfullfilled: think about what is missing.	Inner sweet spot
Motivation: low	Disengaged: you are not touched by the things that give you joy.	Satisfied but bored: you maybe shifting from comfort zone to boredom zone. Set one or two achievable goals that make you jump out of your bed.

CMO		
Personal brand: strong	Known about, but not known	Known, liked and trusted
Personal brand: weak	Feeling invisible	Known, but not known about.

CIO:	Expand contribution: low	Expand contribution: high
Development: high	Capable of more: (*)	Offering your Unique Contribution to the World (UCW)
Development: low	Coasting along: stagnating	The Peter principle: most people are promoted to their level of incompetence

COO hat. The most valuable asset is your attention:
- Create priorities: manage expectations, starting with your own. Things take longer than you anticipated. Question: what are the key priorities and what are the optional extras if I have time?
- Maintain boundaries, time boundaries
- Partner with your manager

CFO hat. Clarity on your goals
- write down your success criteria: *what are all the things that need to be present so that I am satisfied of my work?* **Nightime** factors (things that keep you awake at night) and **Morning** factors (things that drag you out of your bed). **Daytime** factors: things beyond yourself, that make the work meaningful to you. How much are they present in your current situation? 0 to 10
- What you want to be, do and have in your career and life overall. Use three minutes and write a list. It is a wish list, not a to do list. Do it three times to have more ideas. Then make a short list.
- Partner with your manager

CMO hat:personal brand. If you want to go fast go alone, if you want to go far go with others.
- Get feedback on your current brand. Ask people 3 words that they think describe you.
- Make a career stakeholder map. Rate every relationship with red, amber and green to evaluate the health of the relationship. Work and personal life relationships.
- Partner with your manager.

CIO hat: stay relevant and move forward in a way that is right for you with your CIO hat.

Creativity is thinking up new things, innovation is doing new things (Theodore Levitt)

- Treat yourself as a work in progress. The world is VUCA: Volatile, Uncertain, Complex, Ambiguous. BANI: Brittle, Anxious, Nonlinear, Incomprehensible.

- Notice opportunities to progress that may not be obvious.
  Innovation is seeing what everybody has seen and thinking what nobody has thought.
- Partner with your manager

How are you growing yourself today? What else can you try?

3 Strategic Thinking – LinkedIn Learning, Dorie Clark

What is valuable for you. Embrace strategic thinking: asking higher level questions that keep the future and your priorities in mind. Tactical questions are:

- how should I do this?

Strategic thinking:

- Should we be doing this at all?

Get the habit of strategic thinking. The CAN framework:

- C : Clear . Am I clear at what I should be doing right now?
- A : Align . Does it align with the long term priorities that I have?
- N : New Information: Is there new information that ought to be cosidered?

Cultivate the habits:

- **Questioning assumptions.** Why are we doing this?
- Unpack existing habits and practices.
- Observation: much corporate life is about moving faster, but we miss opportunities.
- Reflection. See the book "Stand Out" by Dorie Clark

Make time to be strategic.

- Free your attention
- Create a weekly block
- Enlist a friend
- Use wasted time to do strategic thinking. Questions can be:
  - What should I spend more time doing?
  - What should I spend less time doing?
  - What 20% of my activities lead to 80% of my results?

Get strategic about your career:

You have to align your strategy and how you spend your time to what matters in your organization. To make a difference in the organization.

What is strategy? The path from long term to short term. Strategy are the big-picture choices that you do. First think about the strategy: what person do you want to be, where do you want to work?

Then think about the goals to do it. Operationalize the strategy. Goals are sometimes too big and too complex. So goals are broken down into tactics.

Tactics are the concrete activities you undertake to achieve the goals, and then to reach the strategic obkjectives.

So:

- Strategy: what do you want to be?
- Goals: the milestones to do that.
- Tactics: the steps to achieve the goals.

3.1 Developing your strategic thinking

Consider the future and learn from the past, interpret the past. There are macro trends, that impact society, and micro trends, that impact your industry. To monitor trends:

- read widely and often
- identify well informed people
- Practice "Scenario building" exercizes
- About something that happened: consider that there is a mainstream explanation, but there can be others.

Create an informed strategy the strategy must be informed, not any strategy. A good strategy does not have to be innovative. Consider the future trends in your industry. Solicit input from diverse sources. The problem is that you can be blind to something that you do not know. Have the practice of bringing in new voices. You have to see what is hidden from you.

Get real. The strategy must be real and applies in the real world. Map your assets and your allies. Find key relationships. Identify your constraints. Create specific steps to achieve the strategy.

3.2 Implementing Strategic Thinking

Strategic thinking with your team.

- Do not unveil your strategy at a strategy meeting. That meeting is a ratification meeting. The real work happens beforehand. Systematically briefing key people to get their feedback. Engage in a campaing of preemetings.
- Identify what the objections will be.
- Be prepared to face objectors: individuals who feel threatened by your proposal.
- Create a system for accountability

Measure your success.

- Clarify your goals and metrics
- evaluate your progresses at regular intervals
- Document your processes

Strategic thinking

4 High Performance Habits

- Good habits and high confidence . Successful people have good habits, that they practice deliberately
- Self-awareness and clear purpose; seeking clarity. Service: finding a way to give back to others. The question is : who needs me?

- Physical and mental fitness: exercie also enhances the creation of new neurons
- Inner and outer expectations: inner: self motivation; outer: something done because of someone else. Also is useful to shre your goal with some other people.
- Avoiding distractions: increase productivity, dvide important work from unimportant work.
- Appreciative, giving and aware of what others need to succeed. Lasting connections with peers.
- Taking risks: open about your ambitions demonstrate courage.

5 Effective Listening – LinkedIn Course

5.1 Assessing Your Listening Skills

Listening Intensions, ordered from top to bottom:

- Attending to subtle clues: Book:"The Silent Language", Edward Hall. Tip: watch people.
- Empathizing with the speaker: understand the emotional state of the speaker. It builds a relation with the speaker. Listen and paraphrase emotion and content.
  - Identify with the speaker's feelings
  - Mind your non verbals
  - Use acknowledging responses
  - Avoid discounting phrases
- Recalling Details: See the Tips. If you do not need to act on this information, then recalling details is not important. Otherwise: **what information do I need to remember to take that action?** Exercize: listen to the wheather forecast without images, then try to recall daily temperatures; take notes.
- Understanding the big picture: grasp the overall meaning. Broader scope. Some people are able to attend a long meeting and then they can summarize it in few sentences. Tips. Ask yourself "how will this information impact the company five years from now?" How will I explain this to someone outside the organization? Attend a lecture and then explain the key ideas.
- Evaluating the content: judging the content, do not buy everything, question what you hear. Most of the time we have to form an opinion, decide between options, etc.
  - Is the speaker making a viable argument?
  - Is the evidence presented recent, credible and relevant?
  - Are both pros and cons presented?
  - Is any information misleading?
  - If this was a product, would I buy it?
  - Focus on content only, not on how the information is presented.

Link: Previsioni del tempo

5.1.1 When and how to listen

In any situation, select the best type of listening.
Watch the clip: "Having difficult conversations"

5.2 Challenges to Listening

5.2.1 Getting distracted by internal noise.

Mental filters: sometimes we filter information and situations by assuming what is common in our experience. We tend to hear what we expect to hear. Set aside assumptions.

5.2.2 Multitasking

5.2.3 Paying attention to delivery

- Focus on content
- Paraphrase what you've heard: summarize
- Remove non verbal distractions
- Ask for clarifications if you do not understand because of the accent of the tone of voice

5.2.4 Overwhelming information

Note taking tips: note taking by hand is more efficient than typing. Learning mode:get the big picture. Action mode: capture details. Depending on how you will use that information, write the overall information or the details.

5.2.5 Responding inappropriately

- Making it about yourself: responding with your personal experience while someone is talking about his/hers. The autobiographic response.
- Critizing immediately
- Providing unsolicited advice
- Focusing on the facts and missing the feeling or the big picture.

5.3 Effective Listening Behaviors

5.3.1 Clarify your role

As a listener, you are there to support the speaker. Some want to vent, etc. Clarify with a phrase what your role should be to the speaker: Should I take notes?
Know your information processing preference:

- Valuing logic: analyze first,use cause and effect reasoning, listern for details that may have the most impace.
- Valuing appreciation: listen for compassion, maintain harmony, look how decisions affect others

5.3.2 Use non-verbal cues

- Interjection of agreement
- Facial expressions
- Eye contact
- Personal space

5.3.3 Allow silence

"*The quiter you become, the more you hear*" Ram Dass, Physical and vocal silence. Stay quiet, do not move, be silent. Silence communicates respect-

5.3.4 Paraphrase what is said

5.3.5 Match Emotions

- Posture
- Pacing
- Vocabulary pattern
- tone
- Volume
- Speech pattern

5.3.6 Moreover

ask open ended questions, so they start talking

6 Train your Brain to Unwind Stress and Anxiety Habits – LinkedIn course

Judson Brewer, "Unwinding Anxiety" (YouTube channel)

6.1 Fear vs Anxiety

Fight, flight, freeze, when fear is finished, we learn: this is called negative reinforcement: do not do that in the future. Negative reinforcement has three components: trigger, behavior and result=reward. You just need something unpleasant enough to trigger the brain to learn.

Fear is different from anxiety. Fear is a survival tactic. Anxiety is fear and planning. Planning came later in evolution. Fear and planning: the brain avoids future threats and seeks future revards. Anxiety= looking too far ahear instead of being in the moment. Anxiety is fear of the future. The opposite of anxiety is flow states, which is the real key to optimal performance.

Anxiety is bad: why do we get anxious in the first place? Our brain does not like uncertainty. Fear moves us to reduce uncertainty.

What happens when we bring together fear and uncertainty of the future? We cannot be certain about the future: it is the future. We can do our best to plan for it. When we flip from planning to worrying, it does not reduce uncertainty, it just makes it harder to think and plan. Anxiety makes it harder to think and plan.. Planning is helpful, anxiety is not.

What makes anxiety worse?.. When we plan we gather information and we try to predict the future. Four reasons why it is more difficult to plan today:

- information is limitless:
- information can be contractictory. On the internet, accuracy gets buried under volume.
- Information can be complex
- Information can be unreliable

The brain is not built for the amount of information it can exposed to on the internet, and you cannot be an expert on most things. But you can learn to work with uncertainty and anxiety.

Key concepts: when you mix fear and planning, you get anxiety. Anxiety = fear of the future.

6.2 The Loop: How Stress and Anxiety become a habit

Anxiety can become a habit. The cycle: trigger, behavior, result.

Anxiety is unpleasant, that drives worrying as a behavior, the result is worrying can make you feel in control. Anxiety is not your fault. Anxiety has become a habit. Any learned habit can be unlearned.

The prefontal cortex is the first part that goes off line when we are stressed or anxious, so it is more difficult to control ourself and plan. Willpower is not a muscle, that can be trained. Willpower is mote mith than muscle.

We break bad habits by using something that is older than the prefrontal cortex: awareness.

6.3 Unwinding Anxiety Step 1: Mapping Anxiety Loops

How to map you anxiety loops.

- Trigger:
- Behavior:
- Reward/result:

First try to understand how anxiety loop works in our brain. We can get stuck in trying to figure out why are we anxious (the why). The what is: what are we doing to try to make anxiety go away? The behavior is typically: worrying, distraction or avoidance.

Metacognition: learn to see your thoughts as thoughts: observer effect: the very act of observing a system can influence the outcome or properties of the system being observed. In psychology it is called the Hawthorne effect. The fact of observing participants in psychological studies changed the result. By naming it, we alter our relation with it. "That's an anxious thought.". By observing it, we cannot identify with the thought: we cannot observe it and be the same as the thought. We see it as a thought instead of automatically believing it. This is a shift from cognition to metacognition. The shift comes through awareness. Awareness that we are not our thoughts. We open the space to work with our thought instead of automatically believing it.

6.4 Unwinding Anxiety Step 2: Building Disenchantement

Become disenchanted with your old behavior. Orbitofrontal cortex (OFC).

It is not about forcing yourself to stop, it is about paying attention.

Now step 1 and 2 together: everytime you notice you are getting stuck in a worrying, procrastination or avoidance loop, take a moment to map it out (step 1 = trigger, behavior, result). Step 2 : identify how rewarding or unrewarding the behavior is. Zoom out and ask"*What am I getting from this?*": focus on how it feels in your body, seat with the sensation, notice any accompaning thoughts. How rewarding is the behavior? really.

"Mr. Duffy lived a short distance from his body" - "A Painful Case "by J.Joice.

Notice the signals that your body is sending to you. Somatic awareness:

- Listen
- Be patient and curious
- Try meditation practices

YouTube video about Guided Body Scan Meditation.

6.5 Unwinding Anxiety Step 3: finding more rewarding rewards

Uses the same process as step 2, if you are disenchanted with a behavior, the brain looks for something better to replace it. Find the Bigger, Better Offer (BBO). Curiosity itself. It helps staying flexible and fluid. Panic is a sign that we are overheating. We are overheating when we are not lubricated by curiosity. Stay open to your experience. Curiosity can become your new habit, it is a superpower that can help you deal with difficult states. Curiosity is a BBO than panick or worrying.

How to jumpstart curiosity:

- "*Curiosity will conquer fear more than bravery will*".
- The impediment to action advances action. *What stands in the way becomes the way*.
- Swap worrying with wonder

1. Think about something that makes you a little anxious.
2. Allow you to be anxious and engage the feeling.. Try to feel the anxiety in your body.

3. Now turn it into curiosity. Get curious about the sensations

Avoid trigger questions, like: Why is this happening?, What triggered this?, How long will this last?
Curiosity primers: oh? Explore the now. Notice how oftern your brain falls into the fear-of-future trap. Ask: "Am I resisting any feelings?"

7 LinkedIn Course: Interpersonal Communications

Communicating with colleagues make a request:

- Invest in favors first
- explain the context
- acknowledge it is a favor
- Point out where interests align (maybe you are helping them too)
- Express genuine gratitude
-

When to use the phone or send and e-mail

- Honor the recipient's preference, some people is a listener, some people is a reader.
- Use e-mail when the message is simple to convey and there is no need to interact, when 24/7 functionality matters (timezones), or late at night, or when the recipient is talkative
- When to use the phone: for brainstorming and troubleshooting, when there is an interaction (give and take), when there is an emotional component to the conversation, or a sensitive topic.

How to interpret non verbal clues

- open vs closed body language
- look where feet are pointed to
- look out for mismatched expressions: if someone is smiling but where are no wrinkles around their eyes.
- Expressions of contempt:

Communicating with your Supervisor

Rank your current projects, based on your understanding of priorities. Then setup a meeting with your boss to determine if he thinks the same. Make time estimates. Compare estimations with your boss. Confirm projects deadlines.
Get the guidance you need. In case the Boss is never in the office.

- Discuss how to communicate with the Boss
- Plan regular check-in(s)
- Develop and emergency plan-driven
- Create a Job reference guide

Ask your boss the right questions: What can I be doing that's most helpful to you right now? How should I prioritize that? Do youu see anything I am missing?
Know when to listen and when to speak:
when to listen:

- when you do not know the context of the situation
- when you doo not have a strong opinion

When to speak

- when you have experience to offer
- you have resourcs to share (articles, papers)
- you have a strong opinion
- you have a great question

Communicating in Tricky situations. Everyone has its communication style, but there are also cultural differences. Tips:

- does the culture value relationships or transactions?
- How direct is the communication style? Some europeans are direct, Americans are in the middle, Asians are less direct.
- Is the culture formal or informal?

How to handle an interruption.

- Why am I being interrupted? People may be rude, it can be a sign of interested engagement.
- Who is interrupting me? Just one person? If many perople, it can be the cultural habit. If it is one person, you can discuss in a one on one meeting.
- If it is a team norm , then you can try to disrupt the office culture.

How to respond to a critial feedback.

- Know who to take feedback from: they are: your boss and those you ask for feedback. If you ask for feedback, then listen to it.
- Do not respond immediately. No fight or flight mode. "*Thank you for the feedback, to do it justice, I want to think about it for a while*".
- Prepare for feedback map-out the worst-case scenario, draft possible responses
-

How to communicate as an introvert "the workplace is optimized for extroverts". If you are an introvert, you can fake it: don't do that. Try to:

- play to your strengths:
- share your thoughts in writing before meetings
- ask a friend to advocate for you
- create talking points for yourself, so you know what you want to say: create notes for yourself, as a fallback
- challenge yourself to participate: "In this meeting, I will be the first one to speak up."
- do more prework: meet one on on one before bigger meetings.
-

8 LinkedIn Learning Course: Decision Intelligence

Decision intelligence is turning information into better action at anyscale, in any setting. Decision making, is a bit of an art, a lot of a science, and a skill that you can be better at.

8.1 The Decision maker in isolation

The most important lesson in decision making: the difference between a decision and an outcome. Watch out for outcome bias. A **decision** is an irrevocable allocation of resources, e.g money, or giving up an opportunity. When you choose something, the opportunity to choose the other one goes away. The **outcome** is how things turn-out later. It is possible to make a good decision and have an outcome that is not so good. The outcome has two components: the quality of the decision, and randomness=luck. You have no control over luck.
Always evaluate decisions based only on what was known at the time the decision was made. This goes against intuition. It is difficult to have a clear account from someone who did not document its own decision making process, is less lkely with every passing minute. To evaluate a decision you have to know what information was available at the time. Did the decision maker get the right information based on what was at stake? Was all available information correctly evaluated?
Hindsight bias: Survivorship bias. For important decisions, document the decision making process.
Why are some decisions more difficult than others?

- Number of options: when there are fewer options, the decision is simple; if there are more options ond more combinations of options, it is more difficult-
- Obvious winner: better an apple or a rock? Better an apple or another kind of apple? Fewer stakes make the decision simpler.
- Clear objectives : it makes the decision simpler Low cost makes the decision simpler
- Reversability
- Cognitive effort. Lessburden on the brain makes the decision easier
- Pressure: lower stress makes the decision easier
- Emotional trigger: less emotion makes the decision easier
- Information: do you have enough and reliable information to make the decision?

Risk and ambiguity.
Ambiguity: when you do not known the prbabilities
Rick: when probability * damage is unbearable
Timing: more time makes the probability better.
A decision made in isolation, when no one knows or is affected, is easier.
Adversarial effect: lack ofcompetitors make the decision easier.

When a decision is difficul, pause, slow down, reeiterate

8.1.1 How to set goals

- Think about your priorities and opportunities, before setting goals
- Forming priorities: think about something that other people do, that are non priorities for you

Look at priorities side by side and evaluate them.
Goal setting mistakes: picking goals that are too vague (they are deprioritized) or too concrete (overfocus).
Have layers of goals, that serve different purposes.

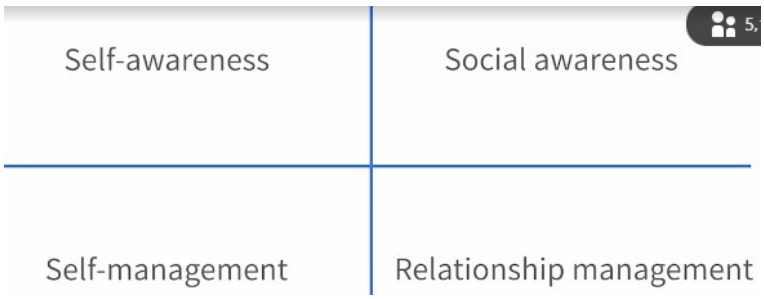
- Outcome goals: what you want to win: the objective (e.g. being into shape: what does it mean?) you do not have control on the outcome
- Performance goals: (i want to run a marathon), measurable, it can be under your control
- Process goals: (I want to run 30 minutes every other day): you have control on the outcome, it is measurable., easy to track,

Never allow proces goals to take over as most important . The process goal must serve the outcome goal
How much effort information and data to put into a decision. Do not underspend or overspend on a decision.
The value of clarvoyant: how much would you pay to have certainty. If you wold not pay much, so it is a low stake decision, do not spend too much time on a decision. Use intuition.
More oeffort on a decision when there is plenty of time, , the decision is important

Hackable Human: heuristics and biases.
Principal agent problem: a conflict of priorities between the owner of a business and the agent managing the business. Solution: create contraints on the agent behavior. The principal is the long term you; the agent is the short term you.
Decisiveness: why are people indecise?

9 Developing Your Emotional Intelligence – LinkedIn Learning course

9.1 Being self-aware



Emotions: feeling you experience. Emotions impact our behavior and relationships. The cycle is: physiological response, then emotion, then a reaction (a behavior).
At work, schedule some time to reflect on the situation. How did I feel? Why? What was the trigger? Did I respond like I typical would? Are there patterns? Is there something deeper? Be aware of your feelings.
Managing your mindset. We rely on cognitive shortcuts to help us making quick decisions. Triggers are events that cause you to feel and think in a way that is not going to give the best outcome. Triggers cause an emotional response and a behavioral response.

- What are your response patterns?
- You usually know the triggers in advance

Finding your flow. An activity that requires concentration, offers growth and provides joy. What are your flow activities?

9.2 Managing yourself

How to break the cycle: emotions => thought => behavior.
ABCDE model:

- **A**: Activating Event: the situation you find yourself in: be objective as a journalist reporting the event
- **B**: Beliefs and thoughts about the event, including your emotional responses.
- **C**: Consequences: what was the outcome when you responded in a given way?
- **D**: Disrupting thought. *How can you replace your belief and feelings about the event with more useful beliefs?*
- **E**: Effect of challenging your thoughts

Example: an unproductive conversation with a team member?
Thinking, Feeling, Reacting: is it possible to break the chain, if it is so fast?: the trick is to choose your reaction. To do that, you need to slow down your reaction time.

- Identify when you are reacting emotionally
- allow space to breathe: to remove yourself from the situation
- give yourself time to recover: let your body recover, Do not make any decision until your emotions are settled
- Choose how you will respond

Shift perspective to shift behavior:

- actively seek alternative views and alternative arguments, rather than seeing them as a nuisance. You can know in advance how someone else will view the situation.
- Ask more questions and really listen
- spend time with new people
- Read more, in general, and more broadly.

9.3 Developing Social Awareness

Social awareness: use your senses to learn more about the world and the people around you. Take notice. Notice people: body language, facial expression, listen to the tone when they talk to you etc. Sensory audit: take a walk for 20 minutes and concentrate on what you feel.
The ability to empathise with others is seen as a key predictor of emotional intelligence. Someone finds empathising difficult. Replace empathy with "understanding perspectives". Acknowledging others' views without feeling the feelings in your body. Image how the person may think or feel, do not try to be certain, do no tmake assumptions. Ask questions to him.

- Set an intention to learn about the other person's perspective.
- Actively explore the other person's perspective. This allows to find solutions more easily. Example questions: "tell me more about where you are coming from", "I really want to understand your perspective about this. What am I missing?"

Practice perspective reflecting.
Listen to improve social awareness Gathering information from others is listening. If you listen:

- you are likely to find a middle ground
- collaborative and respectful relationships
- solutions to challenges :
- you may discover another point of view

There can be emotion nd trying to communicate our point across. In that case take a step back, pause and seek to understand.
Take some time to analyze you r communication style:

- Do you listen well na dhear what they say?
- How do you become a better listener? Before entering a meeting, make a note to yourself about what you want to learn.
- Challenge yourself to learn at least something on every interaction.

9.4 Managing relationships

Authenticity builds trust. Sometimes you need to adapt your communication style and be flexible. That comes back to be socially aware.

- What are your communication strengths? They can be:
  - Communicating your message clearly and effectively
  - Listen to what others are saying
  - Making people feel comfortable and heard
  - Picking up on dynamics quickly
  - Making genuine connections
  - Communicating one-to-one or leading meetings
- How adaptable is your communication style? Do you change your tone if you are in a meeting? Examples of adapting the communication style:
  - Matching your energy level and tone of voice
  - Mirroring body language
  - Consciously showing part of your personality. Eg telling a story about yourself
  - Matching communication styles with others.
  - Before heading to a meeting, reflect: what do I know about the other person's communication style? How can my strengths match their style? How do I adapt my communication style? What can you do more or less?

EQ and positive conflict management Manage conflict in a positive way: this is where emotional inteliigence comes into play.

- Agree on the rules on engagement. There can be a "team manifesto". What does it mean healthy debate?
- Create a robust support system
- Practice "plussing": if you plan to challenge an idea, you must add a constructive suggestion. Use "Yes and ...", "What if..."

How you want to come across may not be how you really come across. Do not focus on the message itself, but on the intention of the message, what you want the other person to take away from the interaction .
Benefits of focusing on intent:

- builds trust
- boosts confidence

- adds flexibility
- provides room for mistakes

Effective communication is about the message received from the other person.

9.5 EQ development plan.

- Vision: what do you want to achieve. "The one thing I want to achieve is: …."
- Mission: why do you want to develop in this area?
- Goals:
- Tactics
- How will you know when you achieved your goal?

10 Biography

ID	Title	Version
[DD20]	"*Software Project Estimation: Intelligent Forecasting, Project Control, and Client Relationship Management*", Dimitre Dimitrov, Apress, 128 pages	2020
[GD19]	"*Software Estimation Without Guessing Effective Planning in an Imperfect World*", G.Dinwiddie, The Pragmatic Programmers, 238 pages.	2019
[IB18]	"*How to Kill the Scrum Monster Quick Start to Agile Scrum Methodology and the Scrum Master Role*", I.Bibik, Apress, 81 pages	2018
[MG19]	"Project management of large software-intensive systems", M. Gechman, CRC Press	2019
[ML13]	"*Managing the Unmanageable*", 458 pages, M.W.Mantle, R.Lichty, Addison Wesley	2013
[SS20]	"*The Scrum Guide The Definitive Guide to Scrum The Rules of the Game*", K.Schwaber J.Sutherland, 14 pages	November 2020
[ST20]	"*Become an Effective Software Engineering Manager - How to Be the Leader Your Development Team Needs*", 384 pages, James Stanier	2020